



D-DAY LANDINGS

On June 6, 1944, US, British, and Canadian troops launched an attack to free western Europe from Nazi control. More than 150,000 soldiers crossed the English Channel to land on the beaches of Normandy in northern France. The invasion was successful, and by the end of the year almost all of France and Belgium had been liberated.



▲ OPERATION BARBAROSSA

Hitler launched Operation Barbarossa on the USSR on June 22, 1941, pouring 3.8 million troops and 3,795 tanks across the border. German troops laid siege to the city of Leningrad for 1,000 days and almost reached the Soviet capital, Moscow, but the harsh Russian winter and food shortages stopped them from taking the city. The USSR then launched a long but successful campaign to push German forces back.

▼ GERMANY SURRENDERS

On April 29, 1945, Soviet troops entered the center of the German capital, Berlin, and a few days later captured the Reichstag, the German parliament building (below). Germany finally surrendered on May 7, bringing the war in Europe to an end.

